



State Employment
Leadership Network

Monthly Network Meeting
June 14, 2017

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SELN Monthly Network Meeting: June 14, 2017

AGENDA

Welcome to everyone!

- Brief intros
- Housekeeping

Discussion

Bringing Employment First to Scale

Project Business

- Upcoming events
- Hub update (www.selnhub.org)



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**Rehabilitation Research Training Center
(RRTC) on Advancing Employment**
Bringing Employment First to Scale

June 2017
SELN Monthly Network Meeting



“Employment is a way for people with disabilities to give to the community and see what they have to offer.

We’re givers, not just takers.”

(Max Barrows, SABE)



Big Picture



RRTC on Advancing Employment for Individuals with IDD



- ❑ Individual and family knowledge and engagement
- ❑ Effective employment supports
- ❑ Organizational change for community providers
- ❑ State-level policy and strategy



Aligning policy and practice across agencies –
What is the vision?



Systems intentionally align:

- Practices (what we do),
- A priority for employment (what we want), and
- Bring components to scale (availability for all)

ThinkWork!

Dialogue

In your experience, which aspects of “systems change” is the most challenging in your work:

- Being intentional (getting and staying focused)
- Aligning activities across your system and different systems
- Prioritizing (choosing certain things over others)
- Bringing to scale (spreading the ideas and expectations to a larger group and building consistency)

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National policy context

- ❖ Employment First
- ❖ HCBS Waiver and CMS language
- ❖ Olmstead and the Department of Justice
- ❖ WIOA



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APSE EMPLOYMENT FIRST STATEMENT
Supporting the Employment First approach

All people with disabilities should have opportunities to work. Public policies should be used to pay for supports for people to work in the community. People with disabilities, their families, and their allies believe that:

- Too many people with disabilities do not have a job. This is unacceptable.
- All people should have opportunities for real jobs with real wages. It will give us real freedom. We will be more independent. We will have more choices.
- All people, with and without disabilities, can work in jobs together earning minimum wage or higher.
- Like everyone else, people with disabilities should have access to supports that they need to work successfully.
- All people, no matter what disability they have, have the right to work a job they choose that matches their skills and interests.
- Public policies must support people with disabilities having real jobs. Money for services should be spent on people having jobs in the community.
- Just calling your state an Employment First state is not enough. "Employment First" is when everyone who wants a job, has a job.

APS | CWSA | Employment First | ThinkWork!

“...Just calling your state an ‘Employment First’ state is not enough; it’s when everyone who wants a job, actually has a job.”
(SABE, 2017).

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Research questions

- ❖ What are the characteristics of “higher performing” employment systems?
- ❖ What is the relationship between systems’ characteristics and employment outcomes?

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The studies

- ❖ Development of state rankings across 3 systems (education, VR, IDD)
- ❖ Case study research of the “highest performers”
- ❖ Digging deeper: policy analysis with state examples

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Key findings: composite indicator

	Rank	Overall CI Score	IDD Score	VR Score	Education Score
MD	1	47.38	21.60	15.22	10.56
NH	2	47.26	22.76	9.63	14.86
VT	3	46.88	22.76	13.75	10.37
OR	4	44.77	21.60	12.81	10.35
WA	5	44.26	22.84	10.87	10.56
IA	6	42.48	15.42	13.78	13.28
OK	7	41.98	21.67	12.79	7.52
SD	8	40.51	14.33	14.72	11.46
CO	9	39.78	14.47	13.92	11.39
DE	10	39.60	19.20	14.32	6.08

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Top Performers Across Systems and States

Top 10 states based on CI Scores (ranked descending order)	Top IDD System Performers	Top VR System Performers	Top Education System Performers
• Maryland • New Hampshire • Vermont • Oregon • Washington • Iowa • Oklahoma • South Dakota • Colorado • Delaware	• Maryland • New Hampshire • Vermont • Oregon • Washington • Oklahoma	• Maryland • South Dakota • Colorado • Delaware	• New Hampshire • Iowa • South Dakota • Colorado

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Emerging findings from CI research - breakdown

Higher-performing states use a greater percentage of total funds for *integrated employment* than lower-performing states (31% versus 5%)

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Emerging findings from CI research -
breakdown

Lower-performing states use a greater
percentage of total funds for *facility-based
non-work* than higher-performing states
(80% versus 34%)

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Emerging findings from CI research -
breakdown

Are lower-performing states less likely to
respond to the ICI annual state
IDD Agency Survey?

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Emerging findings from CI research



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Dialogue

Do the emerging findings resonate with your experiences? And if so, how?



Case studies

Purpose:

- ❖ Investigate elements of higher performing disability employment systems
- ❖ “Modernize” the Higher Performing Model by encompassing multiple agencies that support employment for individuals with IDD.



Why are we conducting the study?

To better understand:

- ❖ How VR and Education support employment for people with IDD
- ❖ How VR and Education practices compare to original Higher Performing model



Why are we conducting the study?

- To better understand (continued):
- ❖ How collaborative policies and practices are being implemented in the top ranked states
 - ❖ The elements of the employment system infrastructure (e.g., outcome data collection, co-training, common credentialing requirements, single point of application) that support outcomes



How is the study being conducted?

- ❖ Selection of case study states (3 in total over 5 years)
- ❖ Document collection and review



How is the study being conducted?

- ❖ Individual and group interviews
 - Current and past administrators (IDD, VR, and ED agency),
 - Community rehabilitation providers
 - Advocacy group members (e.g. Arc, APSE)
 - State DD councils
 - Self advocates and families
 - Training providers
 - State employment consortiums members



How is the study being conducted?

- ❖ Qualitative analysis (interview data and policy documents)
- ❖ Development of individual state profiles
- ❖ Enhancement and expansion of the Higher Performing States Model



Key findings from case study research



- ❖ Long-term success depends on cadre of stakeholders
- ❖ Leadership is most effective when distributed across multiple levels of responsibility



Key findings from case study research



- ❖ Capacity building throughout a state’s entire system
- ❖ Consistent allocation of funds for long-term services for youth existing schools is critical. Cements expectation for collaboration between school and adult service systems.



Dialogue

Let's Hear from our Maryland Colleagues
about their Case Study Experience



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Rehabilitation Research and Training Center on Advancing Employment
for Individuals with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities

A project of



www.ThinkWork.org



Upcoming Events

New membership year kicks off July 1st!

Watch for information on our July 19th Business Meeting open to SELN state primary contacts and state agency Directors.

Recurring monthly network meetings will run September 2017 through June 2018

- 9am or 10am HT/ 12pm PT/ 1pm MT/ 2pm CT/ 3pm ET (90 minutes)
- Third Wednesday of each month
- No meetings in August or October





State Employment Leadership Network

The SELN is a place for states to connect, collaborate, and create cross-community support regarding pressing employment-related issues at state and federal levels for individuals with developmental disabilities.

The SELN was launched in 2006 as a joint program of the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services and the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston.


www.selnhub.org
